

## HERE AND THERE.

### A REFORMED OFFICE-SEEKER.

The National Capital is beginning to be less crowded with the eager and sanguine seekers for Government support. Many of them have literally been starved out. The most instructive thing we have seen on the subject is the story of a disappointed applicant as told to the correspondent of the New York "Sun."

"Being a Democrat, and not having much luck at getting ahead at home, I thought I would get an office in Washington if I could. Letting no one but my wife and a friend know what I was up to, I started. After landing here I saw just as plain as day that the water was too deep for me; besides, hundreds of others a great deal smarter at the business were ahead of me. I had not much money, and so, instead of paying much attention to the office, I began to look around for work or something to make a living while I stayed. To tell you the truth, I had not been much away from home, and never in so large a place before. Somehow I kinder felt I could make it go if only I got a chance; and after I had looked around some and clapped my eye over things I thought I saw chances, if only they were worked right. I have a fancy I have a natural gift for knowing a chance as soon as I see it. I got this idea all at once when I saw so many ways and things; so many persons selling everything and so many buying. I had about \$15, and with it I concluded to start. I had looked around the market, where more money is spent in a day than in my town in a whole year. Why can't I have some of it? thought I. Well, I launched out \$4 for Florida oranges and 50 cents more for a basket. That day I sold half the oranges, and had my money back. How I did work, though!—went everywhere, into the houses and stores, and, somehow, people bought willingly. Maybe it was because I was so earnest about it. The third day I had all the oranges sold, with nearly \$5 profit in my pockets. Better'n office, I began to think. While I was looking around for another chance the dealer from whom I had bought offered me two other boxes, the last of a lot, for \$5.50; nice oranges, too. I knew at once what I could do with them. The next morning I sold them for \$4 a box, \$2.50 profit, without breaking bulk. I had never before made money so fast in all my life. I kept on for two weeks, and I couldn't be hired to take the office I was after. I began to think how well I could fix myself right here in Washington, with my little wife and baby and the boy, who by rights ought to be going to school. You don't want to hear it all. It's but two months and two days since I came, and I have got \$80, and everything paid up. What's better, there are a couple of dealers in the market who say they will back me for anything in reason I want to do. I'm thinking I'll keep on the line I've been going for the present. I see so many chances that sometimes I don't know which to take. I wonder anybody that can work wants an office here. Some of the Georgia fellows hanging around here have come to me for money, but I tell 'em to go to work, for there is a heap more money in it than in any office I know of."

### A FEMALE CRUSOE.

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She was occupied in stripping blubber from a piece of seal-skin which she held across her knee, and using for that purpose a knife made of an iron hoop. In her hut was a fire, beside which she sat talking to herself, and, occasionally shading her eyes with her hand, looked at the men that were in search of her. She received them with much courtesy, bowing and smiling, and showing that this lost child of nature had much of the politeness of a true woman. She took some roots from the bag, roasted them in the fire, and gave them to the men to eat. She gathered up all her food, which was her chief concern, owing to the famines she had experienced, washed herself at the spring, and followed the men cheerfully to the boat. On being taken to Santa Barbara she manifested great delight on seeing the sights of civilization. She became a universal favorite, and was presented with many gifts. Passengers on the Panama steamer that landed there all wanted to see the lost woman of San Nicolas. She related by signs her experience on the island, as she spoke a language that none of the Indians knew, and none of the Spanish fathers, versed in Indian dialects, could understand. Civilization, which prolongs the life of some, shortened that of the woman of San Nicolas. An excessive love of fruit led to her death in Santa Barbara, at the age of fifty. She was buried with the honors of the Catholic Church by the Franciscan Fathers, and her dress and trinkets were sent to Rome and placed in that receptacle of the world's curiosities.

"The story of the lost woman of San Nicolas will always remain a wonderment. Her ingenuity is seen in the palls she made of grass, made to hold water by smearing them with melted asphaltum, and in her bird-skin dresses, her bone needles, her knife of iron hoop, and the language she invented and spoke. It is inexplicable to all who have learned her story how a woman could live eighteen years on an island around which the waves were beating a requiem to hope, getting her food and cooking it without even those facilities which are common to the savage, and making her dresses neatly without the aid of needles except what she carved out of bone. She laid aside one dress for eighteen years, to be worn when the white men should come, of which she had a presentiment. She built her own house, protected herself from the cold, gained supreme control over the wild beasts about her, and preserved her love for men and women for well-nigh two decades of human life alone in the wild. With no previous knowledge of civilization, solitude appeared to have educated her for it. An ordinary woman would have perished with despondency in such a desolate, hungry, naked, hopeless outlook."

### "TO WHAT BASE USES WE MAY RETURN, HORATIO"

Hamlet's gruesome tracing in imagination the dust of Alexander until he finds it stopping a bughole has had a curious parallel in fact. "Imperial Caesar dead and turned to clay," if it has not actually "stopped a hole to keep the wind away," has served the equally ignominious use of making lye to aid the work of an Italian washerwoman. The "Caesar" in question was Plao, the adopted heir of Galba, who succeeded Nere in A.D. 68, and seven months later was murdered in the Forum by his own soldiers. Plao fled to the House of Vestals, and was there slain. Recent excavations have uncovered the House of Vestals, and we can now stand, says a Roman correspondent of the London "Times," at the actual scene where the last act of this tragedy, as it concerns Plao, was performed. The workmen busy in digging the foundations for one of the new line of houses just within the modern Porta Salaria encountered that by no means rare phenomenon of the ground sounding hollow beneath them, and there below they found a vaulted chamber, the hypogeum of a family tomb, with seven handsome marble cippi standing in their places around it—that in which the weeping Verania placed the alabaster urn containing the ashes of her husband exactly 1,816 years ago, and those wherein the remains of his father, one of his brothers, and four other members of his family were deposited. Together with these cippi a beautiful bronze statuette about two feet in height was standing in the tomb, but it was hidden by some of the workmen, and found its way, as was afterwards ascertained, into the possession of a Russian collector, who paid 6,000*fr.* for it and sent it out of Rome at once. The sellers of antiquities obtained in this fashion have never time to haggle about prices, and one may well suppose, therefore, that the statuette was worth at least four times what the thieves or the receiver got for it. But this was not all. When the owner of the property, Signor Maraini, who, naturally enough, in the circumstances, was somewhat tardily informed of the discovery, went down to see it, all the cippi had been opened, and the cinerary urns which were in them had all disappeared, excepting one made of rare Oriental alabaster. It had also been opened and was empty. "Where," asked Signor Maraini, "are the ashes that were in these monuments?" "Ashes?" replied the man as if astonished. "Yes, ashes," repeated Signor Maraini. "Well," he answered, "in truth there were

ashes, and a great many of them, but I never dreamed that they were of the slightest importance, and as they were very white and clean, *le ho raccolte in una cesta, e le ho mandate alla mia moglie per fare il bucato.*" ("I gathered them together into a basket and sent them to my wife to make lye of for her washing.") And thus have the ashes of an Imperial Caesar, adopted by Galba as Tiberius was adopted by Augustus, and accepted by the Senate, been used in this year of grace 1885, more than eighteen centuries after his death, by a Roman washerwoman to cleanse her dirty linen with.

### THE SACRED TOOTH OF BUDDHA.

Legend says that when Buddha was cremated in 543 B.C. his left upper canine tooth was saved from the flames by a disciple. This tooth, it is alleged, was stolen by a Brahman emperor, who ordered the relic to be burned and the ashes buried deep in the earth; but, spurning so dismal a home, the tooth reappeared above the spot in the center of a gold lotus flower that had grown up in a single night. It was then cast, by the order of the emperor, into a deep and filthy pool, which at once became clear as crystal and covered with lotus flowers, on one of which the tooth was resting. It was afterward decided to crush the relic to pieces. It was, therefore, placed on an anvil; but as the ponderous hammer descended, the piece of bone sank into the iron, and remained safe and immovable; from which it afterward disengaged itself in answer to the supplications, and offerings of the Buddhists. These wonderful "miracles" seemed to satisfy the emperor that the relic was genuine, and it was therefore taken to Dantapoor and placed in the great temple there. After many adventures the relic came to Ceylon. A writer in "Casell's Family Magazine" describes a visit to the "Palace of the Sacred Tooth." "At the entrance are two sentry-box-looking constructions with glass windows. These are lamps kept perpetually lighted, the flame not having been allowed to die out for many years. The sanctum is very splendid, the roofs and walls being lined with gold brocade, and the frames of the door inlaid with carved ivory. The air is oppressive with the perfume of flowers and spices. Flowers especially are a favorite offering at Buddha's shrine, and are always present in great profusion. On one occasion no less than 6,480,820 flowers were counted at the shrine, and it is recorded that in the fifteenth century a royal devotee sent 100,000 flowers a day for a considerable time; and each day the flowers were of a different kind. The karundus, or vessel containing the tooth, stands covered on a table of massive silver, richly chased, in the midst of a profusion of valuable articles of jewelry, which are either relics or offerings. The most beautiful in the collection is a bird with wings spread. It is formed entirely of diamonds, rubies, blue sapphires, etc., set in gold, which is hid by a profusion of gems. While we were all admiring this magnificent offering, the priests or monks removed several folds of muslin from the karundus, and discovered a sort of dome of gilded silver, about five feet high, studded with a few gems. When this was removed, another was found underneath, made of beautifully carved gold. This was festooned with jeweled chains, and literally incrustated with all the glittering gems for which Ceylon is so celebrated—sapphires and emeralds of extraordinary size, cat's eyes (much prized), rubies, amethysts, and pearls. Another similar covering, and still another, were taken off, when at last was reached a small case of gold, covered externally with rubies, emeralds, and diamonds, in which, resting on the leaves of a gold lotus, was the tooth itself."

### PROVERBS FROM THE TALMUD.

Among the scraps of popular wisdom preserved in the Talmud, which need no introduction when presented in a Saxon garb, must be reckoned "Walls have ears"—a warning more emphatically conveyed in "Even unfenced fields tell tales." "The strongest rules" is the Jewish variant of "Might is right," and "King's knight, king's right," is about as close to the original Hebrew as it is possible to keep. "A bird in the cage is worth a hundred on the tree" is the Talmudic prototype of our bird in the hand. The moral is the same in "Better a yard of ground than an acre of roof," and "The berry I have got tastes better than the melon I am promised." The last is the most expressive; it smacks of the fireside. "Wine in, secret out;" "Sufficient the pain when it comes;" "Fodder for one, fodder for more;" "Price is the sign of poverty;" and "Don't throw a stone into the well from which you have drunk," suggest their obvious English parallels, while "Light for one, light for a hundred," "Drop by drop the cistern is filled;" "A hundred flatterers, and not one to tell the truth;" "The ass is cold in midsummer;" "Care kills half the man;" "Who goes to the wars must be prepared to lose," and "Buying and selling don't make a merchant" are Talmudic gems of which the setting will be more or less familiar. The common saying about silence being gold finds a parallel in the Jewish "Speech is worth a selah, but silence two." "Better one's own tub than another's cistern" is almost Saxon in its homeliness. "Better the grain one has sown than the bushel one has bought"

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